

Lalita Kumari v. Govt. of Uttar Pradesh (2014)

Mandatory Registration of FIR in Cognizable Offenses

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Citation: (2014) 2 SCC 1 | Bench: 5-Judge Constitution Bench

Core Ratio: Registration of FIR is mandatory under Section 154 CrPC (now BNSS 2023)

if the information discloses commission of a cognizable offense.

Key Takeaways for Students:

- Police cannot conduct preliminary inquiry if cognizable offense is disclosed.
- Permitted limited preliminary inquiry only in specified exceptions (medical, commercial, matrimonial).
- Strengthened rule of law against arbitrary refusal to initiate criminal investigation.